

Lab Guide: Installing OpenVAS / Greenbone Community Edition (GCE)

Objective

Instructions to install and configure the Greenbone Community Edition (formerly OpenVAS) on a Linux system. By the end of these instructions, you will have a working vulnerability scanner accessible via a web interface.

Prerequisites

- Debian-based system, Kali
- Internet connection
- Sudo privileges

Step 1 — Update the System

Before installing any software, make sure your operating system is fully up to date.

Run the following commands in a terminal:

```
sudo apt update
```

```
sudo apt upgrade -y
```

A reboot may be required if the system updates the kernel:

```
sudo reboot
```

Step 2 — Install OpenVAS / GCE

OpenVAS is provided as a package repository. Install it using:

```
sudo apt install openvas -y
```

Step 3 — Initial Setup

Run the setup tool to initialize OpenVAS and download vulnerability feeds. This step may take several minutes:

```
sudo gvm-setup
```

The setup will generate an admin password—make sure to save it.

Step 4 — Verify the Setup

Use the following command to verify all components are properly configured:

```
sudo gvm-check-setup
```

Warnings about new or updating feeds are normal.

Step 5 — Update PostgreSQL Collation

To update the database collation metadata, run:

```
sudo runuser -u postgres -- psql -c "ALTER DATABASE postgres REFRESH COLLATION
VERSION; ALTER DATABASE template1 REFRESH COLLATION VERSION;
```

Step 6 — Create the GVM Database (If Needed)

If database errors were found during setup, recreate the database:

```
sudo runuser -u postgres -- /usr/share/gvm/create-postgresql-database
```

Step 7 — Start GVM Services

Start the Greenbone services with:

```
sudo gvm-start
```

Step 8 — Access the Web Interface

Navigate to the GSA web UI using your browser:

```
https://127.0.0.1:9392
```

You may need to bypass the warning for the self-signed certificate. Log in using the admin credentials from Step 3.